

Faculty of Engineering

**Bachelor's Degree Scheme in
Engineering**

Full-time

Programme Code: 05409

(For 2025/26 cohort)
September 2025

Programme Requirement Document

Bachelor's Degree Scheme in Engineering

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1. General Information

This Programme Requirement Document is for the 2025/26 cohort. Just in case any updated information is necessary after the publication of this booklet, students are requested to refer to the most updated information sent via the Faculty or the programme hosting department(s). Should any discrepancy between the contents of the booklet and the University regulations arise, University regulations always prevail.

1.1. Introduction

Programme Title	Bachelor's Degree Scheme in Engineering 工程學科組合學士課程
Programme Code	05409 (JUPAS Code: JS3005)
Host Department	Faculty of Engineering
Programme Structure	Credit-based
Mode of attendance	Full-time
Duration	4 years
Final Awards	Students will gain one of the following awards upon successful completion of the programme: • BEng (Hons) in Air Transport Engineering • BEng (Hons) in Aviation Engineering • BSc (Hons) in Biomedical Engineering • BEng (Hons) in Electrical Engineering • BEng (Hons) in Transportation Systems Engineering • BEng (Hons) in Electronic Systems and Internet-of-things • BSc (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence and Information Engineering • BSc (Hons) in Information Security • BEng (Hons) in Product Innovation with Marketing • BEng (Hons) in Smart Manufacturing • BSc (Hons) in Engineering Management with Data Analytics • BSc (Hons) in Intelligent Supply Chain • BEng (Hons) in Intelligent Robotics Engineering • BEng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering

1.2. Minimum Entrance Requirements

(a) For entry with HKDSE qualifications

The general minimum entrance requirements are as follows:

HKDSE Subjects	Core Subjects				Elective Subjects (including M1/M2)	
	Chinese Language	English Language	Mathematics	Citizenship and Social Development*	1st Elective	2nd Elective
Level Requirement	3	3	2	Attained	3	3

**An attainment at "Attained" in "Citizenship and Social Development" is required for meeting the entrance requirement but NOT included in the admission score calculation.*

There is no compulsory subject requirement. Preferred subject(s) with the highest weighting for admission score calculation include(s):

- English Language;
- Mathematics;
- Mathematics (Extended part – Calculus and Statistics);
- Mathematics (Extended part – Algebra and Calculus);
- Biology
- Chemistry
- Physics
- Business, Accounting and Financial Studies;
- Business, Accounting and Financial Studies (Accounting);
- Business, Accounting and Financial Studies (Business Management);
- Combined Science: Biology + Chemistry;
- Combined Science: Biology + Physics;
- Combined Science: Physics + Chemistry;
- Design and Applied Technology;
- Economics; and
- Information and Communication Technology;

(b) For those who are applying on the basis of A-Level qualifications (i.e. GCE A-Level/ International A-Level)

- Normally attained B in 3 A-Level subjects; AND
- Satisfy the English Language Requirement

(c) For those who are applying on the basis of IB

- Normally achieved a minimum score of 32; AND
- Satisfy the English Language Requirement

(d) Qualifications equivalent to (a), (b) or (c).

Students with A-Level or IB Diploma qualifications may be given credit transfer upon admission to a maximum of 25% of the award requirements upon admission, depending on their previous study and grade attainments.

1.3 Student Exchanges

Exchanges to Universities overseas for a semester or an academic year are possible through various exchange schemes organised by the University, Faculty or individual departments. While the number of exchanges is limited, students are encouraged to participate to enhance their all-roundedness and broaden their experience.

Credit transfer for students joining exchange programmes will be granted on a case by case basis. Depending on the transferability of credits, students may need to defer graduation after completing the exchange programmes. In order to ensure attaining the pre-requisite knowledge for smooth integration of study in the programme, students will be counselled on subject selection in the visited Universities before they leave for the exchange.

1.4 External Recognition

Most of the BEng(Hons)/BSc(Hons) programmes under this Bachelor's Degree Scheme have been granted full/provisional accreditation from the Hong Kong Institution of Engineers (HKIE). Details are provided in the respective Programme Requirement Documents.

1.5 Summer Term Teaching

Usually, there will be no summer term teaching. Industrial Centre Training or External Training may take place during the summer.

1.6 Normal Duration for Completion of a Programme

Students should complete the programme within the normal duration of the programme as specified in the Programme Requirement Document. Those who exceed the normal duration of the programme will be de-registered from the programme unless prior approval has been obtained from relevant authorities. The study period of a student shall exclude deferment granted for justifiable reasons, and the semester(s) when the student has been approved to undertake the internship. Any semester in which the students are allowed to take zero subjects will be counted towards their total period of registration.

Students who have been registered for the normal duration of the programme may request an extension of their studies for up to one year with the approval of the relevant Heads of Department. Applications for extension of study period beyond one year and up to two years will require the approval from Faculty Board Chairman. Head of Department concerned may extend the normal duration of students with special educational needs for up to two years, based on the recommendations from SAO. Further extension will follow the prevailing regulations.

Students who have exceeded the normal duration of the programme for more than two years and have been de-registered can submit an appeal to the Academic Appeals Committee to request further extension. If the appeal fails, the student shall be de-registered.

To enable student sportsmen to manage their participation in trainings/competitions and academic studies, the normal duration for completion of programmes for students admitted via the OSRS will automatically be extended for two years. Further extension will follow the prevailing regulations.

1.7 Validity Period of Subject Credits

The validity period of subject credits earned is eight years from the year of attainment, i.e. the year in which the subject is completed, unless otherwise specified by the Department responsible for the contents of the subject (e.g. the credit was earned in 2018/19, then the validity period should count from 2019 for eight years). Credits earned from previous studies should remain valid at the time when the student applies for transfer of credits. For exceptional cases such as those stated in (i) to (ii) below, subject offering Departments shall have the discretion to approve the transfer of credits which have exceeded the validity period on a case-by-case basis. All such exceptional cases must be reported to the Faculty Board with full justifications.

Exceptional cases

- (i) Mature learners whose previous studies were mostly completed a long time before their admission to this University, but who have working experience which would have kept them actively involved in the relevant area of study. The flexibility to be granted to these students based on academic comparability of subjects is in line with the policy of the University in promoting life-long learning.
- (ii) Students for whom the expiry of the validity of credits is beyond their control, e.g. due to medical reasons.

2. Aims and Characteristics

2.1 Programme Aims

The Bachelor's Degree Scheme in Engineering covers the following UGC-funded full-time BEng(Hons)/BSc(Hons) programmes offered by the Faculty of Engineering:

- BEng (Hons) in Air Transport Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Aviation Engineering
- BSc (Hons) in Biomedical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Electrical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Transportation Systems Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Electronic Systems and Internet-of-things
- BSc (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence and Information Engineering
- BSc (Hons) in Information Security
- BEng (Hons) in Product Innovation with Marketing
- BEng (Hons) in Smart Manufacturing
- BSc (Hons) in Engineering Management with Data Analytics
- BSc (Hons) in Intelligent Supply Chain
- BEng (Hons) in Intelligent Robotics Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering

Please refer to the respective Programme Requirement Documents for the specific aims of the above programmes.

2.2 Programme Characteristics

This Programme offers the time and flexibility to explore various fields in engineering, helping students make informed decisions about the preferred programme within the Faculty of Engineering.

2.3 Programme Outcomes and Assessment Plan

On successful completion of this Programme, students will possess the professional/academic knowledge and skills as well as the attributes for all-roundedness as specified in the programme outcomes of their selected programme of study. For details on the programme outcomes as well as the learning outcomes assessment plan, please refer to the respective Programme Requirement Documents.

3. Curricula

3.1 Competitive Allocation of Departmental Schemes

The Bachelor's Degree Scheme in Engineering covers the following UGC-funded full-time BEng(Hons)/BSc(Hons) programmes offered by the Faculty of Engineering:

- BEng (Hons) in Air Transport Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Aviation Engineering
- BSc (Hons) in Biomedical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Electrical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Transportation Systems Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Electronic Systems and Internet-of-things
- BSc (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence and Information Engineering
- BSc (Hons) in Information Security
- BEng (Hons) in Product Innovation with Marketing
- BEng (Hons) in Smart Manufacturing
- BSc (Hons) in Engineering Management with Data Analytics
- BSc (Hons) in Intelligent Supply Chain
- BEng (Hons) in Intelligent Robotics Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering

Towards the end of year one, students can choose their preferred departmental scheme within the Faculty of Engineering through a ranking assessment, which considers a combination of entrance qualification score, year-one GPA, and interview performance.

BEng (Hons) Scheme in Aviation Engineering

- BEng (Hons) in Aviation Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Air Transport Engineering

BSc (Hons) Scheme in Biomedical Engineering

- BSc (Hons) in Biomedical Engineering

BEng (Hons) Scheme in Electrical Engineering

- BEng (Hons) in Electrical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Transportation Systems Engineering

BEng (Hons)/BSc (Hons) Scheme in Information and Artificial Intelligence Engineering

- BEng (Hons) in Electronic Systems and Internet-of-Things
- BSc (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence and Information Engineering
- BSc (Hons) in Information Security

BEng (Hons) Scheme in Product Innovation and Smart Manufacturing

- BEng (Hons) in Product Innovation with Marketing
- BEng (Hons) in Smart Manufacturing

BSc (Hons) Scheme in Intelligent Supply Chain and Engineering Management

- BSc (Hons) in Engineering Management with Data Analytics
- BSc (Hons) in Intelligent Supply Chain

BEng (Hons) Scheme in Mechanical Engineering

- BEng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering
- BEng (Hons) in Intelligent Robotics Engineering

In the event that students have taken subjects not relevant to the award they pursue eventually, they may have to take make-up subjects to fulfil the award requirements of the programme they eventually pursue.

The minimum number of academic credits required for graduation of the above awards is given in Table 3.1.1. Credits earned from training are excluded in Table 3.1.1. For more details, please refer to the respective Programme Requirement Documents.

Award	Academic Credits Required
BEng (Hons) in Air Transport Engineering	120
BEng (Hons) in Aviation Engineering	120
BSc (Hons) in Biomedical Engineering	120-124
BEng (Hons) in Electrical Engineering	120
BEng (Hons) in Transportation Systems Engineering	120
BEng (Hons) in Electronic Systems and Internet-of-things	120
BSc (Hons) in Artificial Intelligence and Information Engineering	120
BSc (Hons) in Information Security	120
BEng (Hons) in Product Innovation with Marketing	120
BEng (Hons) in Smart Manufacturing	120
BSc (Hons) in Engineering Management with Data Analytics	120
BSc (Hons) in Intelligent Supply Chain	120
BEng (Hons) in Intelligent Robotics Engineering	120
BEng (Hons) in Mechanical Engineering	120

Table 3.1.1 Credits required for different awards

3.2 Year One Curriculum

All admitted students will embark on a Common Year One curriculum, as shown in Table 3.2.1.

As soon as students have been allocated to one of the departmental schemes, they should refer to and be governed by the respective Programme Requirement Documents.

Year 1	
Semester 1 (15 credits)	Semester 2 (16 credits)
AMA1110 Basic Mathematics I – Calculus and Probability & Statistics (3 credits)	ENG2002 Computer Programming (3 credits)
EIE1005 Fundamental AI and Data Analytics (2 credits)	Faculty Elective II* (3 credits)
GUR CAR I / APSS1L01 Tomorrow's Leader (3 credits)	Free Elective (3 credits)
ENG1004 Professionals in Society I (1 credit)	GUR CAR I / APSS1L01 Tomorrow's Leader (3 credits)
Faculty Elective I* (3 credits)	MM1031 Introduction to Innovation and Entrepreneurship (1 credit)
LCR I English Language Subject (3 credits)	LCR II English Language Subject (3 credits)
Healthy Lifestyle (0 credit)	
ENG2101/IC2117 Applied Engineering Fundamentals (2 training credits)	

Table 3.2.1 Normal progression pattern for students

*List of Faculty Electives

- (a) AMA1120 Basic Mathematics II – Calculus and Linear Algebra
- (b) AP10005 Physics I or AP10006 Physics II ¹
- (c) ENG2003 Information Technology

Students are strongly encouraged to discuss their study plans with the Programme Leader/Academic Advisors. Detailed subject syllabi, outcomes and assessment components are given in the respective Programme Requirement Documents.

3.3 Industrial Centre (IC) Training

Besides taking ENG2101/IC2117 Applied Engineering Fundamentals under the Common Year One curriculum, students are required to take training at the Industrial Centre following the requirements of the respective programmes. Students will not pay any training fee, nor receive any stipend.

4. Management and Operation

4.1 Programme Committee

A Programme Committee, comprising of a Chairman, a Deputy Chairman and representatives from the engineering departments, appointed by the Dean of the Faculty of

¹ Students without Level 2 or above in HKDSE Physics (or Combined Science with a component in Physics), or the equivalent qualifications, are required to complete AP10001 Introduction to Physics (3 credits) first.

Engineering undertakes the overall academic and operational responsibility for the Programme and its development within the defined policies, procedures and regulations of the PolyU.

The Programme Committee is responsible for the academic operation, admission, quality assurance and management of Year One of the programme. It reports to the Faculty Board of Engineering. As soon as students enrolling on this programme have opted for the departmental schemes by end of Year One (Semester Two), they will leave this programme, and join a single departmental scheme.

The membership of the Programme Committee is as follows:

Chairman: Prof. KC Chan (ISE), Programme Leader

Members: Prof. Kam Hung Ng (AAE)
Dr Hin Chung Lau (BME)
Dr Kevin KW Chan (EEE)
Prof. Gary Tsui (ISE)
Prof. Haihui Ruan (ME)

4.2 General Administration

The Faculty of Engineering is the administrative host of the programme. General administration of admission, preparation for Board-of-Examiners meetings and documentations is carried out by the Faculty of Engineering. Individual departments will take up the administration for students once the latter have finalised their departmental scheme choices.

4.3 Student-Staff Consultative Group

The Student-Staff Consultative Group (SSCG) consists of student representatives and members of the Programme Committee. The Group is normally chaired by the Programme Leader/Deputy Programme Leader. It meets on a need basis and should normally meet at least once every semester to discuss student workload, teaching and learning methods and other areas of mutual concern. The reports of SSCG will be included in the annual programme review documents.

4.4 Academic Advisor

Academic advising at PolyU attempts to help students make informed and intelligent academic decisions/choices about their study that suit their intellectual, professional and personal goals. The objectives of academic advising at PolyU are to:

- (a) build up an early connection between the students and the Faculty/their home departments and the University as early as possible;
- (b) provide students with accurate information regarding their academic study;
- (c) help students explore their interests, abilities and aspirations on their study and to formulate appropriate goals;
- (d) provide advice and guidance to students that enable them to develop and pursue a study plan in their undergraduate study;
- (e) connect students to resources, opportunities and support within and outside the University promote academic success.

The main responsibilities of the academic advisor will include:

- (a) Building rapport with the students, serving as a bridge that connects them to the Faculty/their home departments;
- (b) Being accessible and available to students, and responding to their questions and concerns;
- (c) Helping students to consider and clarify their intellectual, professional and personal goals;
- (d) Helping students to develop an appropriate study plan (particularly with regard to their Major), and assisting in their selection of appropriate subjects to achieve their identified goals;
- (e) Clarifying to students academic regulations and requirements, particularly those relating to the Major;
- (f) Identifying students with special learning needs or early signs of learning problems, and referring/encouraging them to seek help or support.

Under the Faculty-based admission system, students enrolled in Common Year One curriculum will be initially assigned with a Designated Academic Advisor from the Faculty for the first year. Another Designated Academic Advisor will be assigned by the department concerned for the subsequent undergraduate years until graduation once the student joins a single departmental scheme. Students will be informed of the arrangements during programme orientation and also via email.

The Designated Academic Advisors appointed for this programme are as follows:

Name	Department	Tel. No.	E-mail address
Prof. Kam Hung Ng	Aeronautical and Aviation Engineering	3400 8232	kam.kh.ng@polyu.edu.hk
Dr Hin Chung Lau	Biomedical Engineering	2766 7674	hinchung.lau@polyu.edu.hk
Dr Kevin KW Chan	Electrical and Electronic Engineering	2766 6169	kevin.kw.chan@polyu.edu.hk
Prof. Gary Tsui	Industrial and Systems Engineering	3400 3254	gary.c.p.tsui@polyu.edu.hk
Prof. Haihui Ruan	Mechanical Engineering	2766 6648	haihui.ruan@polyu.edu.hk

5. Academic Regulations

The academic regulations described below are based on the information known as of May 2025. They are subject to review and changes from time to time. Students will be informed of the changes as and when appropriate. Important information relating to students' studies is also published in the Student Handbook (website: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/ar/students-in-taught-programmes/student-handbook/>).

5.1 Subject Registration and Withdrawal

- 5.1.1 In addition to programme registration, students need to register for the subjects at specified periods prior to the commencement of the semester. An add/drop period will also be scheduled for each semester/term. Students may apply for withdrawal of their registration on a subject after the add/drop period and before the commencement of the examination period if they have a genuine need to do so. The application should be made to the Faculty of Engineering (during year-1 of study) and will require the approval of both the subject

lecturer and the host Department Programme Leader concerned (or an alternate academic staff authorised by the programme offering Department). Applications submitted after the commencement of the examination period will not be considered. For approved applications of subject withdrawal, the tuition fee paid for the subject will be forfeited and the withdrawal status of the subject will be shown in the assessment result notification and transcript of studies, but will not be counted in the calculation of the GPA.

- 5.1.2 The pre-requisite requirements of a subject must have been fulfilled before a student registers for that subject. However, the subject offering Faculty/Department has the discretion to waive the pre-requisite requirements of a subject, if deemed appropriate. If the pre-requisite subject concerned forms part of the requirements for award, the subject has to be passed in order to satisfy the graduation requirements for the programme concerned, despite the waiving of the pre-requisite.
- 5.1.3 Subject to the maximum study load of 21 credits per semester and the availability of study places, students are allowed to take additional subjects on top of the prescribed credit requirement for award before they become eligible for graduation. Students will be allowed to take additional subjects for broadening purpose, after they fulfil the graduation requirements and for the following semester. However, they will still be subject to the maximum study load of 21 credits per semester and the availability of places in the subjects concerned, and their enrolment will be arranged as subject-based students only and be subject to the rules on 'Admission of Subject-based Students', except that graduates from UGC-funded programmes will not be restricted to taking only subjects from a self-financed programme.

5.2 Study Load

- 5.2.1 For students following the progression pattern specified for their programme, they have to take the number of credits and subjects, as specified in the Programme Requirement Document from the relevant programme offering Faculty/Department, for each semester. Students cannot drop those subjects assigned by the faculty/department unless prior approval has been given by the faculty/department.
- 5.2.2 The normal study load is 15 credits in a semester for full-time study. The maximum study load to be taken by a student in a semester is 21 credits, unless exceptional approval is given by the Dean of the Faculty in year-1 or by the Head of the programme offering Department after year-1. For such cases, students should be reminded that the study load approved should not be taken as grounds for academic appeal.
- 5.2.3 To help improve the academic performance of students on academic probation, these students will be required to take a reduced study load in the following semester (Summer Term excluded). The maximum number of credits to be taken by the students varies according to the policies of individual Faculties/Departments and will be subject to the approval of the authorities concerned.
- 5.2.4 Students are not allowed to take zero subject in any semester, including the mandatory summer term as required by some programmes, unless they have obtained prior approval from the programme offering Faculty/Department; otherwise they will be classified as having unofficially withdrawn from their programme. Students who have been approved for zero subject enrolment (i.e. taking zero subject in a semester) are allowed to retain their student status and continue using campus facilities and library facilities. Any semester in which the students are allowed to take zero subject will nevertheless be counted towards the total period of registration.

- 5.2.5 Students who have obtained approval to pace their studies and students on programmes without any specified progression pattern who wish to take more than the normal load of 15 credits in a semester should seek advice from the Faculty/Department concerned before the selection of subjects.

5.3 Subject Exemption

Students may be exempted from taking any specified subjects, including mandatory General University Requirements (GUR) subjects, if they have successfully completed similar subjects previously in another programme or have demonstrated the level of proficiency/ability to the satisfaction of the subject offering Department. However, for applications which are submitted by students who have completed an approved student exchange programme, the subject exemption is to be decided by the programme offering Faculty/Department in consultation with the subject offering Departments. If students are exempted from taking a specified subject, the credits associated with the exempted subject will not be counted towards the award requirements. It will therefore be necessary for the students to consult the programme offering Faculty/Department and take another subject in order to satisfy the credit requirement for the award.

5.4 Credit Transfer

- 5.4.1 Students may be given credits for recognised previous studies including mandatory General University Requirements (GUR) subjects; and the credits will be counted towards meeting the requirements for award. Transferred credits may not normally be counted towards more than one degree. The granting of credit transfer is a matter of academic judgment.
- 5.4.2 Credit transfer may be done with or without the grade being carried over; the former should normally be used when the credits were gained from PolyU. Credit transfer with the grade being carried over may be granted for subjects taken from outside the University, if deemed appropriate, and with due consideration to the academic equivalence of the subjects concerned and the comparability of the grading systems adopted by the University and the other approved institutions. Subject credit transfer is normally decided by the subject offering Faculty/Department. However, for applications which are submitted by students who have completed an approved student exchange programme, the decision will be made by the programme offering Department in consultation with the subject offering Departments.
- 5.4.3 Normally, not more than 50% of the credit requirement for award may be transferable from approved institutions outside the University. For transfer of credits from programmes offered by PolyU, normally not more than 67% of the credit requirement for award can be transferred. In cases where both types of credits are being transferred (i.e. from programmes offered by PolyU and from approved institutions outside the University), not more than 50% of the credit requirement for award may be transferred.
- 5.4.4 If a student is waived from a particular stage of study on the basis of advanced qualifications held at the time of admission, the student concerned will be required to complete fewer credits for award. For these students, the 'deducted' credits at admission stage will be counted towards the maximum limit for credit transfer when students apply for further credit transfer after their admission.
- 5.4.5 All credit transfers approved will take effect only in the semester for which they are approved. A student who applies for transfer of credits for a particular semester will only be eligible for graduation at the end of that semester (even if the granting of credit transfer will immediately enable the student to satisfy the credit requirement for the award).

- 5.4.6 Regarding credit transfer for GUR subjects, the Faculty is the approval authority at the time of admission to determine the number of GUR credits which an Advanced Standing student will be required to complete for the award concerned. Programme Host Faculties/Departments should make reference to the mapping lists of GUR subjects, compiled by the Committee on General University Requirements (CoGUR), on the eligibility of the subjects which can qualify as GUR subjects. Applications for credit transfer of GUR subjects after admission will be considered, on a case-by-case basis, by the subject offering Department or College of Undergraduate Studies (CUS)/Service-Learning and Leadership Office (SLLO), in consultation with the relevant Sub-committee(s) under CoGUR, as appropriate.
- 5.4.7 For credit transfer of retaken subjects, the grade attained in the last attempt should be taken in the case of credit transfer with grade being carried over. Students applying for credit transfer for a subject taken in other institutions are required to declare that the subject grade used for claiming credit transfer was attained in the last attempt of the subject in their previous studies. If a student fails in the last attempt of a retaken subject, no credit transfer should be granted., despite the fact that the student may have attained a pass grade for the subject in the earlier attempts.
- 5.4.8 Students should not be granted credit transfer for a subject which they have attempted and failed in their current study unless the subject was taken by the student as an exchange-out student in his/her current programme.

5.5 Deferment of study

- 5.5.1 Students may apply for deferment of study if they have a genuine need to do so such as illness or posting to work outside Hong Kong. Approval from the programme offering Faculty/Department is required. The deferment period will not be counted towards the total period of registration.
- 5.5.2 Application for deferment of study from students who have not yet completed the first year of a full-time programme will only be considered in exceptional circumstances.
- 5.5.3 Where the period of deferment of study begins during a stage for which fees have been paid, no refund of such fees will be made.
- 5.5.4 Students who have been approved for deferment are not entitled to enjoy any campus facilities during the deferment period.

5.6 General Assessment Regulations

- 5.6.1 These General Assessment Regulations shall govern all full-time 4-year undergraduate degree programmes.
- 5.6.2 Students progress by credit accumulation, i.e. credits earned by passing individual subjects can be accumulated and counted towards the final award.
- 5.6.3 A 'level' in a programme indicates the intellectual demand placed upon students and may characterise each subject with respect to its recommended sequencing within that programme. Upper level subjects should normally build on lower level subjects. Pre-requisite requirements, if any, must therefore be spelt out on a subject basis.

5.6.4 A 'subject' is defined as a discrete section of the programme which is assigned a separate assessment. A list of subjects, together with their level and weightings, shall be published in the Programme Requirement Document.

5.6.5 The language of assessment shall be English, unless approval is given for it to be otherwise.

5.7 Principles of Assessment

5.7.1 Assessment *of* learning and assessment *for* learning are both important for assuring the quality of student learning. Assessment *of* learning is to evaluate whether students have achieved the intended learning outcomes of the subjects that they have taken and have attained the overall learning outcomes of the academic programme at the end of their study at a standard appropriate to the award. Appropriate methods of assessment that align with the intended learning outcomes should be designed for this purpose. The assessment methods will also enable the teacher to differentiate students' different levels of performance within the subject. Assessment *for* learning is to engage students in productive learning activities through purposefully designed assessment tasks.

5.7.2 Assessment will also serve as feedback to students. The assessment criteria and standards should be made explicit to students before the start of the assessment to facilitate student learning, and feedback provided should link to the criteria and standards. Timely feedback should be provided to students so that they are aware of their progress and attainment for the purpose of improvement.

5.7.3 The ultimate authority in the University for the confirmation of academic decisions is the Senate, but for practical reasons, the Senate has delegated to the Faculty Boards the authority to confirm the decisions of Boards of Examiners (BoE) provided these are made within the framework of the General Assessment Regulations. Recommendations from BoE which fall outside these Regulations shall be ratified by the Academic Planning and Regulations Committee (APRC) and reported to the Senate as necessary.

5.8 Assessment Methods

5.8.1 Students' performance in a subject can be assessed by continuous assessment and/or examinations, at the discretion of the individual subject offering Department. Where both continuous assessment and examinations are used, the weighting of each in the overall subject grade shall be clearly stated in the Programme Requirement Document. The subject offering Faculty/Department can decide whether students are required to pass both the continuous assessment and examination components, or either component only, in order to obtain a subject pass, but this requirement (to pass both, or either, components) shall be specified in the Programme Requirement Document. Learning outcome should be assessed by continuous assessment and/or examination appropriately, in line with the outcome-based approach.

5.8.2 Continuous assessment may include tests, assignments, projects, laboratory work, field exercises, presentations and other forms of classroom participation. Continuous Assessment assignments which involve group work should nevertheless include some individual components therein. The contribution made by each student in continuous assessment involving a group effort shall be determined and assessed separately, and this can result in different grades being awarded to students in the same group.

5.8.3 Assessment methods and parameters of subjects shall be determined by the subject offering Faculty/Department.

- 5.8.4 At the beginning of each semester, the subject teacher will inform students of the details of the methods of assessment to be used, within the assessment framework as specified in the Programme Requirement Document.

5.9 Progression/Academic Probation/ Deregistration

- 5.9.1 The Boards of Examiners (BoE) shall, at the end of each semester (except for Summer Term unless there are students who are eligible to graduate after completion of Summer Term subjects, or the Summer Term study is mandatory for the programme), determine whether each student is
- (i) eligible for progression towards an award; or
 - (ii) eligible for an award; or
 - (iii) required to be deregistered from the programme.
- 5.9.2 When a student has a Grade Point Average (GPA) (see para. 5.13.3 below) lower than 1.70, he/she will be put on academic probation in the following semester. If a student is able to pull his/her GPA up to 1.70 or above at the end of the semester, the status of “academic probation” will be lifted. The status of “academic probation” will be reflected in the assessment result notification but not in the transcript of studies.
- 5.9.3 A student will have 'progressing' status unless he/she falls within any one of the following categories which shall be regarded as grounds for deregistration from the programme:
- (i) the student has reached the final year of the normal period of registration for that programme, as specified in the Programme Requirement Document, unless approval has been given for extension; or
 - (ii) the student has reached the maximum number of retakes allowed for a failed compulsory subject; or
 - (iii) the student's GPA is lower than 1.70 for two consecutive semesters and his/her Semester GPA in the second semester is also lower than 1.70; or
 - (iv) the student's GPA is lower than 1.70 for three consecutive semesters.
- 5.9.4 When a student falls within the categories as stipulated above, except for category (i) with approval for extension, the BoE shall de-register the student from the programme without exception.
- 5.9.5 A student may be de-registered from the programme enrolled before the time frame specified in para. 5.9.2(iii) or (iv) above if his/her academic performance is poor to the extent that the BoE deems that his/her chance of attaining a GPA of 1.70 at the end of the programme is slim or impossible.
- 5.9.6 The progression of students to the following academic year will not be affected by the GPA obtained in the Summer Term, unless Summer Term study is mandatory for all students of the programme and constitutes a requirement for graduation, and is so specified in the Programme Requirement Document.
- 5.9.7 If the student is not satisfied with the de-registration decision of the BoE, he/she can lodge an appeal. All such appeal cases will be referred directly to the Academic Appeals

Committee (AAC) for final decision. Views of Faculties/Schools/Departments will be sought and made available to AAC for reference.

5.10 Retaking of Subjects

- 5.10.1 Students may only retake a subject which they have failed (i.e. Grade F or S or U). Retaking of subjects is with the condition that the maximum study load of 21 credits per semester is not exceeded.
- 5.10.2 The number of retakes of a subject should be restricted to two, i.e. a maximum of three attempts for each subject is allowed.
- 5.10.3 In cases where a student takes another subject to replace a failed elective subject, the fail grade will be taken into account in the calculation of the GPA, despite the passing of the replacement subject. Likewise, students who fail a Cluster Area Requirement (CAR) subject may need to take another subject from the same Cluster Area in order to fulfill this part of the GUR, since the original CAR subject may not be offered; in such cases, the fail grade for the first CAR subject will be taken into account in the calculation of the GPA, despite the passing of the second CAR subject.
- 5.10.4 Students need to submit a request to the Faculty Board for the second retake of a failed subject.
- 5.10.5 Students who have failed a compulsory subject after two retakes and have been deregistered can submit an appeal to the Academic Appeals Committee (AAC) for a third chance of retaking the subject.
- 5.10.6 In relation to 5.10.5 above, in case AAC does not approve further retakes of a failed compulsory subject or the taking of an equivalent subject with special approval from the Faculty, the student concerned would be de-registered and the decision of the AAC shall be final within the University.

5.11 Exceptional Circumstances

Absence from an assessment component

- 5.11.1 If a student is unable to complete all the assessment components of a subject, due to illness or other circumstances which are beyond his/her control and considered by the subject offering Faculty/Department as legitimate, the Faculty/Department will determine whether the student will have to complete a late assessment and, if so, by what means. This late assessment shall take place at the earliest opportunity, and normally before the commencement of the following academic year (except that for Summer Term, which may take place within 3 weeks after the finalisation of Summer Term results). If the late assessment cannot be completed before the commencement of the following academic year, the Faculty Board Chairman shall decide on an appropriate time for completion of the late assessment.
- 5.11.2 The student concerned is required to submit his/her application for late assessment in writing to the Head of Department offering the subject, within five working days from the date of the examination, together with any original supporting documents. Approval of applications for late assessment and the means for such late assessments shall be given by the Head of Department offering the subject or the subject lecturer concerned, in consultation with the Programme Leader. Verification of the supporting documents with the issuing authority may be conducted by the subject offering Department as part of the approval process.

Assessment to be completed

- 5.11.3 For cases where students fail marginally in one of the components within a subject, the BoE can defer making a final decision until the students concerned have completed the necessary remedial work to the satisfaction of the subject examiner(s). The remedial work must not take the form of re-examination.

Aegrotat award

- 5.11.4 If a student is unable to complete the requirements of the programme in question for the award due to very serious illness, or other very special circumstances which are beyond his/her control, and considered by the Board of Examiners (BoE) as legitimate, the Faculty Board will determine whether the student will be granted an aegrotat award. Aegrotat award will be granted under very exceptional circumstances.
- 5.11.5 A student who has been offered an aegrotat award shall have the right to opt either to accept such an award, or request to be assessed on another occasion to be stipulated by the BoE; the student's exercise of this option shall be irrevocable.
- 5.11.6 The acceptance of an aegrotat award by a student shall disqualify him/her from any subsequent assessment for the same award.
- 5.11.7 An aegrotat award shall normally not be classified, and the award parchment shall not state that it is an aegrotat award. However, the BoE may determine whether the award should be classified, provided that they have adequate information on the students' academic performance.

Other particular circumstances

- 5.11.8 A student's particular circumstances may influence the procedures for assessment, but not the standard of performance expected in the assessment.

5.12 Grading

5.12.1 Assessment grades shall be awarded on a criterion-referenced basis. A student's overall performance in a subject shall be graded as follows:

<i>Subject grade</i>	<i>Short description</i>	<i>Elaboration on subject grading description</i>
A+ A A-	Excellent	Demonstrates excellent achievement of intended subject learning outcomes by being able to skillfully use concepts and solve complex problems. Shows evidence of innovative and critical thinking in unfamiliar situations, and is able to express the synthesis or application of ideas in a logical and comprehensive manner.
B+ B B-	Good	Demonstrates good achievement of intended subject learning outcomes by being able to use appropriate concepts and solve problems. Shows the ability to analyse issues critically and make well-grounded judgements in familiar or standard situations, and is able to express the synthesis or application of ideas in a logical and comprehensive manner.
C+ C C-	Satisfactory	Demonstrates satisfactory achievement of intended subject learning outcomes by being able to solve relatively simple problems. Shows some capacity for analysis and making judgements in a variety of familiar and standard situations, and is able to express the synthesis or application of ideas in a manner that is generally logical but fragmented.
D+ D	Pass	Demonstrates marginal achievement of intended subject learning outcomes by being able to solve relatively simple problems. Can make basic comparisons, connections and judgments and express the ideas learnt in the subject, though there are frequent breakdowns in logic and clarity.
F	Fail	Demonstrates inadequate achievement of intended subject learning outcomes through a lack of knowledge and/or understanding of the subject matter. Evidence of analysis is often irrelevant or incomplete.

'F' is a subject failure grade, whilst all others ('D' to 'A+') are subject passing grades. No credit will be earned if a subject is failed.

Indicative descriptors for modifier grades

Main Grade (solid)	The student generally performed at this level, indicating mastery of the subject intended learning outcomes at this level.
+(exemplary)	The student consistently performed at this level and exceeded the expectations of this level in some regards, but not enough to claim mastery at the next level.
-(marginal)	The student basically performed at this level, but the performance was inconsistent or fell slightly short in some regards.

Note: The above indicative descriptors for modifier grades are not applicable to the pass grades D and D+

5.12.2 A numeral grade point is assigned to each subject grade, as follows:

<i>Grade</i>	<i>Grade Point</i>
A+	4.3
A	4.0
A-	3.7

B+	3.3
B	3.0
B-	2.7
C+	2.3
C	2.0
C-	1.7
D+	1.3
D	1.0
F	0.0

5.12.3 At the end of each semester/term, a Grade Point Average (GPA) will be computed as follows, and based on the grade point of all the subjects:

$$\text{GPA} = \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N \text{Subject Grade Point}_n \times \text{Subject Credit Value}_n}{\sum_{n=1}^N \text{Subject Credit Value}_n}$$

where N = number of all subjects (inclusive of failed subjects) taken by the student up to and including the latest semester/term. For subjects which have been retaken, only the grade point obtained in the final attempt will be included in the GPA calculation

In addition, the following subjects will be excluded from the GPA calculation:

- (i) Exempted subjects
- (ii) Ungraded subjects
- (iii) Incomplete subjects
- (iv) Subjects for which credit transfer has been approved, but without any grade assigned²
- (v) Subjects from which a student has been allowed to withdraw (i.e. those with the code 'W')

Subject which has been given an "S" code, i.e. absent from assessment components, will be included in the GPA calculation and will be counted as "zero" grade point. GPA is thus the unweighted cumulative average calculated for a student, for all relevant subjects taken from the start of the programme to a particular point of time. GPA is an indicator of overall performance, and ranges from 0.00 to 4.30 from 2020/21.

5.12.4 For programmes with training components, whether these training credits³ will be counted in the GPA calculation will be decided by the programme offering Department.

5.13 Different Types of GPA's

5.13.1 GPA will be calculated for each Semester including the Summer Term. This Semester GPA will be used to determine students' eligibility to progress to the next Semester alongside with the 'cumulative GPA'. However, the Semester GPA calculated for the Summer Term will not be used for this purpose, unless the Summer Term study is mandatory for all students of the programme concerned and constitutes part of the graduation requirements.

² Subjects taken in PolyU or elsewhere and with grades assigned, and for which credit transfer has been approved, will be included in the GPA calculation.

³ "Training credits" is used as a generic term only, and also includes clinical/field credits for programmes in different study disciplines. Laboratory experiments done as a subject/an integral part of a subject to satisfy the academic requirements is not considered to be practical training.

- 5.13.2 The GPA calculated after the second Semester of the students' study is therefore a 'cumulative' GPA of all the subjects taken so far by students, and without applying any level weighting.
- 5.13.3 Along with the 'cumulative' GPA, a weighted GPA will also be calculated, to give an indication to the Board of Examiners (BoE) on the award classification which a student will likely get if he/she makes steady progress on his/her academic studies.
- 5.13.4 When a student has satisfied the requirements for award, an award GPA will be calculated to determine his/her award classification.
- 5.13.5 For students taking the Major/Minor study route, separate GPA will be calculated for their Major and Minor programmes. The Major GPA will be used to determine their award classifications, which will be so reflected on the award parchment. The Minor GPA can be used as a reference for BoE to moderate the award classification for the Major, as explained further in para. 5.15.7.
- 5.13.6 For students taking the Major/Secondary Major study route, there is no separate "Secondary Major GPA". The Major GPA is the weighted GPA of all subjects contributing to the Major and Secondary Major.

5.14 University Graduation Requirements

- 5.14.1 To be eligible for a Bachelor's Degree award under the 4-year full-time undergraduate curriculum, a student must:
- (i) Successfully complete the requisite number of credits stipulated for the award;
 - (ii) Earn a cumulative GPA of 1.70 or above at graduation;
 - (iii) Complete successfully the mandatory Work-Integrated Education (WIE) component and IC training requirements stipulated for the award;
 - (iv) Satisfy the GUR requirements as specified in the Programme Requirement Document

Areas	Credits
▪ Language and Communication Requirements (LCR) ⁴	9
▪ Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics (AIDA) Requirement	2
▪ Innovation and Entrepreneurship (IE) Requirement	1
▪ Leadership Education and Development	3
▪ Service-Learning	3
▪ Cluster-Area Requirements (CAR) ○ 3 credits from CAR(M): Chinese History and Culture ○ 3 credits from each of the following 2 cluster areas - CAR(A): Human Nature, Relations and Development - CAR(N): Cultures, Organisations, Societies and Globalisation And of which must fulfill 2 additional requirements: ○ English Reading and Writing (ER/EW) Requirements ○ Chinese Reading and Writing (CR/CW) Requirements	9

⁴ Non-Chinese speakers and those students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below will by default be exempted from the CAR - Chinese Reading and Writing requirements. However, students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below will still be required to take one Chinese LCR subject to fulfil their Chinese LCR.

Areas	Credits
▪ Healthy Lifestyle	Non-credit bearing
Total GUR credits	27

- (v) Satisfy the residential requirement for completing at least 1/3 of the credits required for the award he/she is currently enrolled, unless the professional bodies concerned stipulate otherwise; and
- (vi) Satisfy any other requirements as specified in the Programme Requirement Document.

5.14.2 There are subjects which are designed to fulfil the credit requirement of different types of subject. Students passing these subjects will be regarded as having fulfilled the credit requirements of the particular types of subject concerned. Nevertheless, the subject passed will only be counted once in fulfilling the credit requirements of the award, and the students will be required to take another subject in order to meet the total credit requirement of the programme concerned.

5.14.3 Level-0 subjects and training subjects (including clinical/field training) will not be counted to fulfill free elective requirement for graduation purpose.

Language and Communication Requirements (LCR)

5.14.4 LCR comprises three major components of the overall English and Chinese language requirements as described below in order to be eligible for graduation:

- (i) Language and Communication Requirements (LCR) in English (6 credits) and Chinese (3 credits), as stated in 5.14.5 and 5.14.6 below;
- (ii) Writing Requirement (W), as stated in 5.14.7 below; and
- (iii) Reading Requirement (R), as stated in 5.14.8 below.
- (iv) Discipline-Specific Language Requirement, as stated in 5.14.9 below.

English

5.14.5 All undergraduate students must successfully complete two 3-credit English language subjects* as stipulated by the University, according to their English language proficiency (Table 1). These subjects are designed to suit students' different levels of English language proficiency at entry, as determined by their HKDSE score or the English Language Centre (ELC) entry assessment (when no HKDSE score is available).

Table 1: English LCR Subjects (3 credits each)

English language competence level	Subject		
	Practical English for University Studies (ELC1011)	English for University Studies (ELC1012/ELC1013)	Any LCR Proficient level elective subject in English (Table 2)
HKDSE Level 4 and above or equivalent	--	Subject 1	Subject 2
HKDSE Level 3 or equivalent	Subject 1	Subject 2	--

Table 2: Proficient level elective subjects for DSE Level 4 students and above (or equivalent) (3 credits each)

	Subject Title	Subject Code
LCR Proficient level elective subjects	Advanced English Reading and Writing Skills	ELC2011
	Persuasive Communication	ELC2012
	English in Literature and Film	ELC2013
	Advanced English for University Studies	ELC2014

* Students entering the University with specified attainment grades in certain public examinations can be given credit transfer or exemption for one or both LCR English subjects. For the subject exempted, students must take any other subject to make up the 3 credits. For the subject granted credit transfer, student do not need to take any other subject to make up the credits. For details, please consult your programme offering Department.

Chinese

5.14.6 All undergraduate students are required to successfully complete one 3-credit Chinese language subject* as stipulated by the University, according to their Chinese language proficiency level (Table 3).

Cantonese will be used as the Medium of Instruction (MoI) of a certain proportion of Chinese LCR subject (Table 3). Students taking the Cantonese version of the subjects will be offered a 39 hour non-credit bearing e-Learning course in Putonghua (optional).

Table 3: Chinese LCR Subjects (3 credits each)

Subject Code	Subject Title	MoI
CLC1104C	University Chinese	Cantonese
CLC1104P	University Chinese	Putonghua

For non-Chinese speaking students or students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below:

Students of non-native Chinese language background, fulfilling any one of the following criteria with appropriate supporting certificate/document (if applicable), could be **exempted from the CLCR** at the time of admission. You may use a CLCR subject or free elective to fulfil the credit requirement. You are also **exempted from fulfilling the CR/CW of CAR**.

1. those with their first/native language as non-Chinese stated on the grade report of recognized tests (e.g. IELTS, TOEFL, etc.); OR
2. those admitted with international qualifications without taking any Chinese subject(s) in their secondary/ high school; OR
3. those taken Chinese B or Chinese AB(SL) in IB Diploma; OR
4. NCS status shown on the official proof provided by their secondary school.

Otherwise, one subject from Table 4 will be pre-assigned to you as Chinese LCR depending on your Chinese language proficiency and/or previous exam results. You might be given an assessment to ascertain that the pre-assigned subject is suitable for you.

Table 4: Chinese LCR Subjects for non-Chinese speakers or students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below

Subject Code	Subject Title
CLC1151	Chinese I (for non-Chinese speaking students)
CLC1152	Chinese II (for non-Chinese speaking students)
CLC2151	Chinese III (for non-Chinese speaking students)
CLC2154	Chinese IV (for non-Chinese speaking students)
CLC2152	Chinese Literature – Linguistic and Cultural Perspectives (for non-Chinese speaking students)

* Students entering the University with specified attainment grades in certain public examinations can be given **credit transfer** or **exemption** for the LCR Chinese subjects. For the subject exempted, students must take any other subject to make up the 3 credits. For the subject granted credit transfer, student do not need to take other subject to make up the credits. For details, please consult your Programme Offering Department.

Writing Requirement

- 5.14.7 In addition to the LCR in English and Chinese explained above, all students must also, among the Cluster Areas Requirement (CAR) subjects they take (see para. 5.14.14 below), pass one subject that includes the requirement for a substantial piece of writing in English and one subject with the requirement for a substantial piece of writing in Chinese.

Reading Requirement

- 5.14.8 All students must, among the CAR subjects they take, pass one subject that includes the requirement for the reading of an extensive text in English and one subject with the requirement for the reading of an extensive text in Chinese.

A list of approved CAR subjects for meeting the Writing Requirement (with a "W" designation) and for meeting the Reading Requirement (with an "R" designation) is shown at: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/cus/GURSubjects/CAR.php>.

Non-Chinese speakers and those students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below will by default be exempted from the DSR - Chinese and CAR - Chinese Reading and Writing requirements. However, students whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below will still be required to take one Chinese LCR subject to fulfil their Chinese LCR.

Discipline-Specific Language Requirement

- 5.14.9 In addition to the LCR and Reading and Writing Requirements, students also have to complete 2-4 credits of discipline-specific language requirements (2 credits in English and 0-2 credits in Chinese) as specified in the curriculum requirements of their Major.

Students who are non-Chinese speakers or those whose Chinese standards are at junior secondary level or below will be exempted from the Discipline-Specific Chinese Language requirement. These students must take another subject to make up for the total credit requirement.

Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics (GUR-AIDA) Requirement

- 5.14.10 GUR-AIDA subjects aim to help students demonstrate an understanding of the foundational concepts of AIDA, acquire basic skills in using AIDA technologies and applications, articulate examples of how the adoption AIDA could enhance students' chosen disciplines and demonstrate an awareness of global contemporary ethical issues and impact from AIDA applications in daily life.

4-year degree students are required to complete a 2-credit for GUR-AIDA within the first year of study. Senior year intakes students are required to take the mandatory subject "Essential Components of General Education" for the e-module on GUR-AIDA.

Innovation and Entrepreneurship (GUR-IE) Requirement

- 5.14.11 GUR-IE subjects aim to help students to demonstrate an elementary understanding of innovation and entrepreneurship, appreciate the importance of innovation and entrepreneurship in local and global community, appreciate the applications and implications of the latest technologies on entrepreneurship and innovation in their chosen disciplines and identify ethical issues in entrepreneurship and innovation.

4-year degree students are required to complete a 1-credit for GUR-IE within the first year of study.

Leadership Education and Development (LEAD)

- 5.14.12 LEAD aims to introduce students to the concepts and theories of leadership and to prepare them to become ethical leaders. The "Online Tutorial on Academic Integrity", National Education and the "learning-to-learn" component are embedded in the LEAD subjects.

4-year degree students are required to complete a 3-credit for LEAD.

A list of designated subjects for meeting the leadership education and development requirement is available at: https://www.polyu.edu.hk/cus/?sc_lang=en.

Service-Learning (SL)

- 5.14.13 SL aims to help students develop into a competent professional with a heart to serve others. This subject contains a significant service component which allows them to apply their skills and knowledge to deal with complex issues in social service, and develop a stronger empathy for people in need and a stronger sense of civic responsibility.

All students must complete one 3-credit SL subject. Some SL subjects are embedded in the major study curriculum and to be taken as Major subjects. However, the majority of PolyU students will need to choose SL subjects on their own. Please check the respective Programme Requirement Documents for details.

A list of designated subjects for meeting the service-learning requirement is available at: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/cus/GURSubjects/SL.php>.

Cluster Areas Requirements (CAR)

5.14.14 CAR aims to expand students' intellectual capacity beyond disciplinary domains and to enable them to tackle professional and global issues from a multidisciplinary perspective.

Students are required to successfully complete at least one 3-credit subject each of three out of the following four Cluster Areas as stipulated in the respective Programme Requirement Document, among which students have to fulfill the Reading and Writing Requirements in Chinese and English (CR/CW and ER/EW):

- Human Nature, Relations and Development (CAR (A))
- Science, Technology and Environment (CAR (D))
- Chinese History and Culture (CAR (M))
- Cultures, Organisations, Societies and Globalisation (CAR (N))

A list of CAR subjects under each of the four Cluster Areas is available at: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/cus/GURSubjects/CAR.php>.

Healthy Lifestyle

5.14.15 The Healthy Lifestyle Programme (HLS) is a set of courses and activities covering different dimensions of health that aims to help students build up a healthy lifestyle, which is an important and positive aspect to promote success in the university. Students are required to complete HLS before graduation. Details of the programme can be found at: <https://www.polyu.edu.hk/cus/student/4-year-undergraduate-student/general-university-requirements/healthy-lifestyle/>.

5.15 Guidelines for Award Classification

5.15.1 In using these guidelines, the Board of Examiners (BoE) shall exercise its judgement in coming to its conclusions as to the award for each student, and where appropriate, may use other relevant information.

5.15.2 The Weighted GPA will be used as a guide to help determine award classifications. It is calculated as follows:

$$\text{Weighted GPA} = \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N \text{Subject Grade Point}_n \times \text{Subject Credit Value}_n \times W_n}{\sum_{n=1}^N \text{Subject Credit Value}_n \times W_n}$$

where W_n = weighting to be assigned according to the level of the subject

N = number of all subjects counted in GPA calculation as set out in para. 5.12.3, except those exclusions specified in para. 5.15.3 below.

For calculating the weighted GPA (and award GPA) to determine the Honours classification of students who satisfy the graduation requirements of Bachelor's degree awards, a University-wide standard weighting¹⁸ will be applied to all subjects of the same level, with a weighting of 2 for Level 1 and 2 subjects, a weighting of 3 for Level 3 and 4 subjects. Same as for GPA, Weighted GPA ranges from 0.00 to 4.30 from 2020/21.

5.15.3 Any subjects passed after the graduation requirement has been met or subjects taken on top of the prescribed credit requirements for award shall not be taken into account in the grade point calculation for award classification (see para. 5.12.3 and 5.15.3 above). However, if a student attempts more elective subjects (or optional subjects) than those required for

graduation in or before the semester in which he/she becomes eligible for award, the elective subjects (or optional subjects), except for subjects which are selected by students to fulfill the free electives requirement for graduation, with a higher grade/contribution shall be included in the grade point calculation (i.e. the excessive subjects attempted with a lower grade/contribution, including failed subjects, will be excluded).

Students taking the Major (including the Major/Secondary Major option)/Minor studies)

- 5.15.4 For students who have completed a Major (including the Major/Secondary Major option)/Minor programme, a single classification will be awarded and their award classification will mainly be based on the “Major GPA”, but it can be moderated by the BoE with reference to the “Minor GPA”. For students who have completed a Major programme combined with free electives, their award classification will be determined by their “Major GPA” which includes grades obtained for the free electives, if appropriate.
- 5.15.5 “Major GPA” is derived based on all subjects of the Major programme, as well as the Secondary Major programme, if any, including those meeting the mandatory General University Requirements (GUR) and programme-specific language requirement, but not necessarily including the training credits.
- 5.15.6 “Minor GPA” is derived based on the 18 credits of specific Minor programme. “Minor GPA” is unweighted.
- 5.15.7 The “Major GPA” and the “Minor GPA” will be presented separately to the BoE for consideration. The guidelines for determining award classification as stipulated in Section 5.16 below are applicable to programmes with Major (including the Major/Secondary Major option)/Minor studies.

Students taking the Double Major option

- 5.15.8 The derivation of GPA for award classification for the First Major and Second Major (particularly on the counting of subjects common to both Majors) will be decided by the Department offering the Major programme. Students will be given two award parchments, one for each Major programme, which will be issued upon completion of both Majors. The honours classification of the two Major awards need not be identical.

5.16 Classification of Awards

- 5.16.1 For Honours degree programmes, the awards will be classified as follows:

First Class Honours
Second Class Honours (Division 1)
Second Class Honours (Division 2)
Third Class Honours

5.16.2 The following are guidelines for Board of Examiners' reference in determining award classifications:

<i>Honours degrees</i>	<i>Guidelines</i>
First Class Honours	The student's performance/attainment is outstanding, and identifies him/her as exceptionally able in the field covered by the programme in question.
Second Class Honours (Division 1)	The student has reached a standard of performance/ attainment which is more than satisfactory but less than outstanding.
Second Class Honours (Division 2)	The student has reached a standard of performance/ attainment judged to be satisfactory, and clearly higher than the 'essential minimum' required for graduation.
Third Class Honours	The student has attained the 'essential minimum' required for graduation at a standard ranging from just adequate to just satisfactory.

5.16.3 Under exceptional circumstances, a student who has completed an Honours degree programme, but has not attained Honours standard, may be awarded a Pass-without Honours degree. A Pass-without-Honours degree award will be recommended, when the student has demonstrated a level of final attainment which is below the 'essential minimum' required for graduation with Honours from the programme in question, but when he/she has nonetheless covered the prescribed work of the programme in an adequate fashion, while failing to show sufficient evidence of the intellectual calibre expected of Honours degree graduates. For example, if a student in an Honours degree programme has a Grade Point Average (GPA) of 1.70 or more, but his/her Weighted GPA is less than 1.70, he/she may be considered for a Pass-without-Honours classification. A Pass-without-Honours is an unclassified award, but the award parchment will not include this specification.

5.16.4 Students who have committed academic dishonesty or non-compliance with examination regulations will be subject to the penalty of the lowering of award classification by one level. For undergraduate students who should be awarded a Third class Honours degree, they will be downgraded to a Pass-without-Honours. The minimum of downgraded overall result will be kept at a Pass. In rare circumstances where both the Student Discipline Committee and the Board of Examiners (BoE) of a Department consider that there are strong justifications showing the offence to be less serious, the requirement for lowering the award classification can be waived.

5.16.5 The following are the award GPA ranges for determining award classifications:

<i>Honours degrees</i>	<i>Award GPA</i>
First Class Honours	3.60 – 4.30
Second Class Honours (Division 1)	3.00 – 3.59
Second Class Honours (Division 2)	2.40 – 2.99
Third Class Honours	1.70 – 2.39

Decisions by the BoE on award classifications to be granted to each student on completion of the programme shall be ratified by the Faculty Board (of Examiners). For cases the decisions

of which do not conform to the above GPA range, they should be referred, by the Faculty Board (of Examiners), to the APRC for ratification.

5.17 Recording of Disciplinary Actions in Students' Records

- 5.17.1 With effect from Semester One of 2015/16, disciplinary actions against students' misconducts will be recorded in students' records.
- 5.17.2 Students who are found guilty of academic dishonesty or non-compliance with examination regulations will be subject to the penalty of having the subject result concerned disqualified and be given a failure grade with a remark denoting 'Disqualification of result due to academic dishonesty/non-compliance with examination regulations'. The remark will be shown in the students' record as well as the assessment result notification and transcript of studies, until their leaving the University.
- 5.17.3 Students who have committed disciplinary offences (covering both academic and non-academic related matters) will be put on 'disciplinary probation'. The status of 'disciplinary probation' will be shown in the students' record as well as the assessment result notification, transcript of studies and testimonial during the probation period, until their leaving the University. The disciplinary probation is normally one year unless otherwise decided by the Student Discipline Committee.

5.18 Minor, Secondary Major and Double Major

The 4-year undergraduate degree framework allows students to work for a single discipline Major, a Major plus a Minor (unless the Major is so designed as to preclude the possibility of a further Minor study), a Major plus a Secondary Major (for programmes joining the 'X+Schemes') or Double Major.

Minor Study

- 5.18.1 Minor study will be a free choice by students and not mandatory. Each student is allowed to take not more than one Minor. Students who opt for Minor study will be subject to the following regulations:-
- (i) A Minor programme is a collection of subjects totalling 18 credits with at least 50% (9 credits) of the subjects at Level 3 or above;
 - (ii) Students interested in a Minor must submit their applications to and obtain approval from the Minor-offering Department, at the start of second year of study. Students should submit their applications to their Major Department, which will indicate its support or otherwise (since the taking of a Minor will increase the student's study load), before the Minor-offering Department makes a final decision on the application;
 - (iii) Students are expected to complete their approved Minor as part of their graduation requirements. Students who wish to withdraw from a Minor need to apply for approval officially from the Minor-offering Department, normally before the end of the add/drop period of the last Semester of study;
 - (iv) Students with approved Minor will be given a higher priority in taking the Minor subjects over the students who take the subjects as free-electives. 'Free electives' under the 4-year Ug degree programmes refers to any subjects offered by the University, unless otherwise specified;

- (v) Subject to approval by the Minor-offering Department, students may count up to 6 credits from their Major/GUR [including Language Communication Requirement (LCR) subjects at proficiency level] towards their chosen Minor; Nevertheless, students must take at least 6 credits from their chosen Minor programme in order to satisfy the residential requirement of their chosen Minor. In addition, to be eligible for the Major and Minor awards, the total number of credits taken by the students for their Major-Minor studies must not be lower than the credit requirement of the single discipline Major programme;
- (vi) Credit transfer can be given for not more than 9 credits of a Minor programme if the previous credits were earned from approved institutions outside of the university; and not more than 12 credits of a Minor programme if the previous credits were earned from programmes offered by PolyU;
- (vii) Only students with a GPA of 2.5 or above can be considered for Minor study enrolment. The Minor-offering Department may set a quota and additional admission requirements for their Minor; and
- (viii) Students are required to obtain a GPA of at least 1.70 to satisfy the requirement for graduation with a Major plus a Minor.

Notwithstanding para. 5.18.1 (iv) above, there is no guarantee that a clash-free timetable can be provided for all students who pursue Minor study.

Secondary Major

5.18.2 Studying on a Secondary Major is a free choice by students and not mandatory. Each student may take not more than one Secondary Major. Students who opt for a Secondary Major will be subject to the following regulations:-

- (i) Students are expected to complete the "X + Secondary Major" within the normal duration of the major programme.
- (ii) Students may count up to 12 credits of their Major/GUR subjects towards the Secondary Major. Nevertheless, students must take at least 12 credits from their chosen Secondary Major in order to satisfy the residential requirement of the chosen Secondary Major. Students who have completed more than 12 credits of subjects that are eligible for double counting will need to apply for graduation and indicate the subjects intended for double counting. Notwithstanding the above, students must meet the minimum credit requirements of the "X + Secondary Major" concerned.
- (iii) Students must apply to and obtain approval from the programme offering Department, normally no later than the commencement of the second year of study, to be admitted to the Secondary Major.
- (iv) Only students with a Cumulative GPA of 2.70 or above may be considered for Secondary Major enrolment. Each Secondary Major may stipulate additional selection criteria for admission.
- (v) Students must complete the Secondary Major as part of their graduation requirements. Students who wish to withdraw from the Secondary Major must obtain approval from the programme offering Department normally before the end of the add/drop period of the last semester of study.

- (vi) If deemed appropriate by the programme offering Department, students are allowed to take a Major with a Secondary Major and a Minor. Subjects already double-counted for the Major and Secondary Major cannot be used to fulfil the Minor requirement.

Double Major

5.18.3 Double Major will provide an opportunity for the more capable students, who are interested in expanding their study beyond a single degree, to take a Second Major study. Students who opt for a Double Major study will be subject to the following regulations:

- (i) Completion of Double Major requires more than the normative study period of 4/5 years and extra credits on self-financed basis (therefore require higher tuition fee). The total credit requirements of a Double Major will depend on the degree of commonality between the 2 Majors. Apart from the 30 credits of GUR subjects, up to 1/3 of the First Major which are common to the Second Major can be double-counted towards the Second Major.
- (ii) Students who wish to take a Second Major must obtain approval from the host Department of the first Major. They can then submit their applications to the second Major-offering Department starting from their second year of study. Only students with a GPA of 3.0 or above can be considered for admission to a Second Major, while Departments offering the Second Major can stipulate a higher GPA requirement if appropriate.
- (iii) Students enrolled in a second Major will be given priority in taking second Major subjects over the students who take the subjects as free electives.
- (iv) Students will be put on academic probation if they fail to obtain a GPA of 1.70 or above.
- (v) Students are required to obtain an overall GPA of at least 1.70, in order to satisfy the requirement for graduation with Double Major. They will not be allowed to graduate with one of the 2 Majors.
- (vi) Students who wish to withdraw from a Second Major must obtain approval from the Department offering the Second Major, normally before the end of the add/drop period of the last Semester of study.
- (vii) Students will not be allowed to withdraw from a First Major and continue with the Second Major only.

5.19 Graduation

A student is required to graduate as soon as he/she satisfies the graduation requirements as stipulated in para. 5.14.1 above. The student concerned is required to apply for graduation, in the semester in which he/she is able to fulfil all his/her graduation requirements, and after the add/drop period for that semester has ended.

6. Syllabi

The syllabi for the following subjects to be taken in Year One are given in the following pages.

Subject Code	Subject Title
AMA1110	Basic Mathematics I – Calculus and Probability & Statistics
AMA1120	Basic Mathematics II – Calculus and Linear Algebra
AP10001	Introduction to Physics
AP10005	Physics I
AP10006	Physics II
APSS1L01	Tomorrow's Leader
EIE1005	Fundamental AI and Data Analytics
ENG1004	Professionals in Society I
ENG2002	Computer Programming
ENG2003	Information Technology
ENG2101/IC2117	Applied Engineering Fundamentals
MM1031	Introduction to Innovation and Entrepreneurship